MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation and test infrastructure engineer with 7 years of experience, including ownership of CI/CD pipelines and ephemeral test environments for three product teams. Improved pipeline speed and reliability through parallelisation, dependency caching, and Kubernetes-based environments. Builds Helm charts for test workloads on a shared Kubernetes cluster and has personal hands-on experience with k3s, GitOps, Terraform, and observability tooling. BEng in Computer Engineering; currently preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and Containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose

Infrastructure and Platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm charts for test environments), k3s, Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)

Monitoring and Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Languages and Scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems and Tools: Linux, Git

Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics; personal Hetzner VPS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies, and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by approximately 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL, and seeded data; they are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL test-results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team, helping teams identify and address recurring failures.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Authored an internal guide to the CI system used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal Project | 2024–2025

- Set up a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki for monitoring, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Developed a GitLab CI and Helm workflow to deploy a short-lived application and PostgreSQL environment for each merge request on the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against the environment; automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching, and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)